

Reader Experience Survey

Participant Instructions

Thank you for participating in this survey!

My name is Iglika Nikolova-Stoupak, and this research is part of my PhD at Sorbonne University, entitled “Automatic Literary Adaptation: A Multilingual Approach”.

You will be asked to **read a text** adapted for learners of English and **answer several questions** about it. The survey will take approximately **20 minutes** to complete. You will be entered in a draw to receive a **€5 Amazon voucher** for your participation.

If you have any questions or would like to learn more about the project, please contact me at: {email}

English Proficiency

What is your approximate level of English?

The CEFR (Common European Framework of Reference for Languages) describes language ability on a scale from A1 (beginner) to C2 (proficient). If you know your official or course level, please select it. Otherwise, choose the description that best matches your ability:

A2 (elementary): I can understand short, simple texts and common everyday language.

B1 (intermediate): I can understand the main points of clear texts about familiar topics and follow a straightforward story.

B2 (upper-intermediate): I can understand the main ideas and important details of more complex texts and follow an extended story or argument.

Survey Organisation

Each participant read one version of one literary extract. The literary texts themselves are not reproduced in this questionnaire file. The comprehension questions depended on the book and CEFR level, while the remaining evaluation questions were the same for every text and adaptation type. The B1 and B2 versions of The Picture of Dorian Gray cover the same episode and therefore used the same comprehension questions. Correct answers to the comprehension questions are shown in bold.

Comprehension Questions

Moby-Dick — A2

1. What work has the narrator done before?

He has been a captain.

He has been a whaler.

He has been a sailor.

He has worked in Nantucket.

2. Why does Starbuck tell the narrator what happened to Captain Ahab?

To explain why Ahab is resting

To show that Ahab is a poor captain

To warn him about the dangers of whaling

To compare Ahab to a pirate

3. What does Queequeg do?

He kills a bird.

He demonstrates that he is a good whaler.

He warns the narrator that Ahab is bad.

He tells the narrator to go home.

The Picture of Dorian Gray — B1 and B2

Note: The B1 and B2 extracts cover the same episode and used the same comprehension questions.

1. Who is Sibyl?

A member of the audience

An actress in the play

Dorian's wife

The theatre's manager

2. Why does Sibyl believe that she can no longer act well?

She is scared of the audience.

She is ill and cannot remember her lines.

She is in love and her emotions on stage seem unreal.

She does not want Dorian to watch her perform.

3. What does Dorian's reaction show about his love for Sibyl?

He loves her more after understanding her explanation.

He only cares about what his friends think.

He loves her only because of her talent as an actress.

He wants her to leave the theatre so that they can be alone.

Moby-Dick — B2

1. What unusual object does Queequeg use to shave?

A knife

A tomahawk pipe

A harpoon

A piece of mirror

2. Which statement about Queequeg is NOT true?

He is described as a cannibal

He prays to a small statue

He has a handsome face

He works at the hotel

3. How does the narrator's opinion of Queequeg change?

At first he likes Queequeg, but later he becomes afraid of him.

At first he is afraid of Queequeg, but later he realizes that Queequeg is friendly.

At first he thinks Queequeg cannot use a harpoon, but then he realises he uses one very well.

At first he thinks Queequeg cannot speak English, but then he realises that he can.

Questions Asked After Every Text

The following questions were identical for all survey versions.

1. Do you know which book the text is from?

Yes / No / It sounds familiar, but I am not sure.

2. If you answered "Yes", what is the name of the book? [free-text response]

3. Did you find the text interesting? 1–5 rating scale

4. Did you like the text's style? 1–5 rating scale

5. What do you think will happen next? [free-text response]

Instructions at the End of the Survey

Participation Voucher and Follow-up

Thank you for filling in the survey! If you would like to be considered for a €5 Amazon voucher for your participation, please provide your email address and preferred Amazon domain.

Email address [free-text response]

Amazon domain [enumeration of Amazon domains]

May I contact you at the email address above about a second survey in the next few months?

Yes / No